

State policy vs. Government policy

How does political balance affect public policy approval?

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Motivation



Figure 1: Brazil and Mexico

- Strictness in policy design and implementation (De La O, 2013);
- Temptation to politicize in a polarized scenario;
- The political “balance” Abramovay and Lotta, 2022.

Summary

- RQ: Does political balance affect the approval of public policies?
- Objectives
 - 1) Mapping the relationship between ownership and institutionalization;
 - 2) Analyzing the effects of partisanship on policy approval;
 - 3) Evaluating how institutionalization shapes public opinion.

The politics of policies

- The power of partisanship (Abramowitz and Webster 2018);
- From “issue ownership” to policy ownership (Petrocik 1996);
- Politicization? Not always.

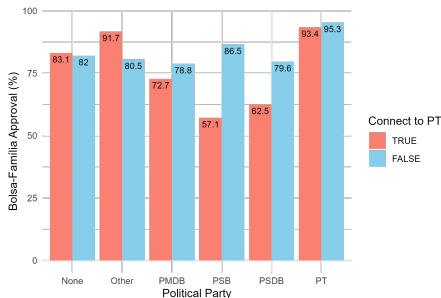


Figure 2: Mean PBF Approval by Party

The institutionalization of policies

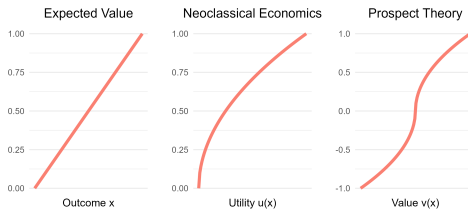


Figure 3: Main Utility Functions

- The rules (North 1990) and their entrenchment (Levitsky and Murillo 2009);
- Policy feedback literature;
- Non-Politicization? Not always;
- Status quo bias and loss aversion (Kahneman and Tversky 1979).

Hypotheses

- H1: Institutionalization is not associated with policy ownership;
- H2a: Alignment with the policy owner positively affects policy approval;
- H2b: Misalignment with the policy owner negatively affects policy approval;
- H2c: Policy ownership negatively affects non-partisans' policy approval;
- H3: Institutionalization positively affects the policy approval.

Empirical strategy

- Choice-based conjoint experiment (Hainmueller, Hopkins, and Yamamoto 2014);
- Two surveys:
 - 1) Conjoint ($N = 245$)
 - 2) Conjoint + Questions about real policies ($N = 285$)

Study 1

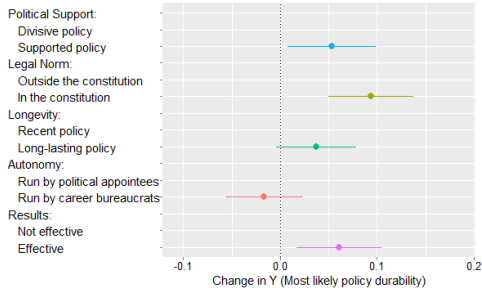


Figure 4: Conjoint AMCE

Study 2

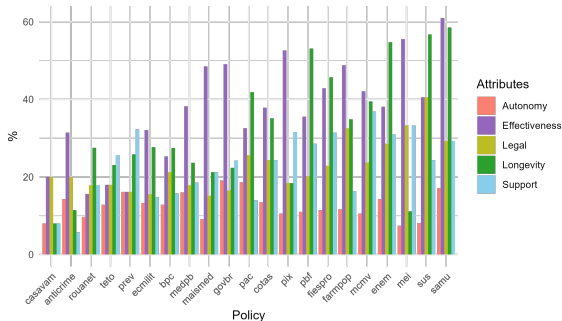


Figure 5: Perceived attributes of the policies

Study 3

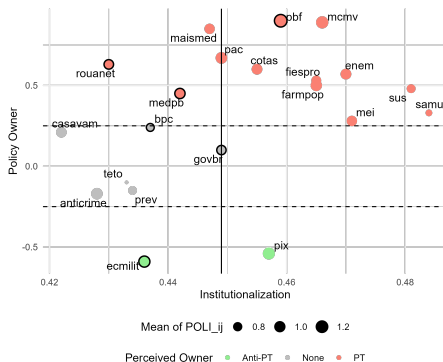


Figure 6: 2x3 Summary

Study 3

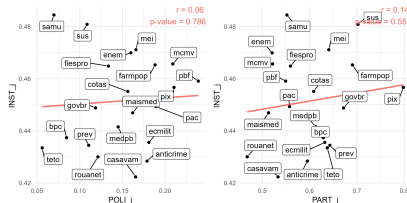


Figure 7: H1 Aggregated Test

- Individual-level test (H1):

- 1) Institutionalization $\rightarrow$ Policy ownership (0.14, $p < 0.01$);
- 2) Institutionalization $\rightarrow$ Alignment with the owner (0.06, $p > 0.05$).

Study 3

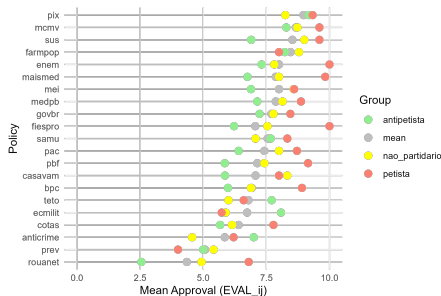


Figure 8: Approval of Policies

- Individual-level test (H2 and H3):

- 1) Alignment with the owner -> Approval (0.40, $p < 0.001$);
- 2) Policy ownership -> Approval (0.12, $p < 0.001$).
- 3) Institutionalization -> Approval (0.33, $p < 0.001$).

Conclusions

- Contributions:

- 1) Methodological;
- 2) Theoretical;
- 3) Practical.

- Limitations:

- 1) Potential reverse causality;
- 2) Potential confounders;
- 3) Limited sample;
- 4) Unexplored method.

- Future agenda.

References I

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References II

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